IGNATIUS BOOK FAIRS

IN-PERSON BOOK FAIR CHECKLIST

Your step-by-step guide to a successful Catholic in-person book fair

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STEP 1 You Did It!

- [x] Choose Ignatius Book Fairs and set your fair dates
  *You've already accomplished this step! Check out our **Resources** throughout this guide.*

STEP 2 Design Your Book Fair Experience

- [ ] Give your community advance notice of the book fair schedule so they can plan their visit
- [ ] Share the Backpack Flyer the week before your fair opens
- [ ] Keep your fair open one or more evenings and/or over the weekend
  Consider hosting an evening event with snacks, beverages, and socializing
- [ ] Consider being open around the Mass schedule to reach more families
- [ ] Extend advertising to homeschoolers, co-ops, and families at neighboring parishes

STEP 3 Recruit Volunteers

- [ ] Create an online sign-up using a free service like SignUpGenius
- [ ] Recruit volunteers to help with: unboxing and setup, scanning in boxes, decorating the space, working the floor suggesting books, running the check-out station, organizing refreshments, running a craft table for kids, promoting on social media, and packing up

STEP 4 Set Up Your Space

- [ ] Arrange tables away from walls in a space of at least 800 sq ft
- [ ] Plan for 12–16 six-foot tables (or equivalent):

Early Readers	**1 table**	🔵
Picture Books	**2–3 tables**	🔴🟢🟡
Elementary Books	**3 tables**	🟢🔵🔴
Middle School Books	**1–3 tables**	🟡🔴🔵
Seasonal / Comic Books	**1–2 tables**	🔴🟢
Crafts & Activities / Toys	**1–2 tables**	🔵🟡
Older Readers & Adults	**1 table**	🟢
Check-out Station	**1–2 tables**	🟡🔴

- [ ] Plan additional tables for snacks/beverages or a coloring page station for younger kids
- [ ] Have on hand: bags for purchases, a cashbox for cash sales, a Sharpie, packing tape

STEP 5 Calendars & Scheduling

- [ ] Add fair details (times, dates, location) to the school and parish calendars
- [ ] Use our Advertising Resources for help with graphics

STEP 6 Advertise Early & Often

- [ ] Post a Save-the-Date announcement 4–6 weeks before the fair
- [ ] Advertise weekly leading up to opening day using our Advertising Resources
- [ ] During the fair, post photos of what's available
- [ ] Before the last day, remind your community of their last chance to shop
- [ ] Places to advertise: parish bulletin, calendar, and email list; announcement from the pulpit; invitation to local parishes in the diocese; school newsletter and paper; school & parish websites, Facebook, Instagram, X; library flyers; announcements to homeschoolers and co-ops

STEP 7 Join Our Live Workshop

- [ ] Watch for email invitations to our 3-part live workshop series
  Part 1: ~90 days out • Part 2: ~60 days out • Part 3: month of your fair
- [ ] RSVP yes to receive recordings even if you can't attend live
- [ ] Invite your volunteer team to join

STEP 8 Receive Your Book Fair Supplies

- [ ] One week before your fair, we deliver: all books and items for sale, 2 payment devices, table category signs in acrylic frames, 50 book stands, colorful tablecloths (mint, yellow, orange), and 5 decorative posters. Add your own flair with seasonal themes, student art, balloons, or twinkle lights!

STEP 9 Delivery & Set-Up

- [ ] Confirm receipt of 20–38 boxes delivered one week before your fair
- [ ] Find the box marked **Open First** — plug in payment devices to charge
- [ ] Find the marketing box and set up tablecloths, category signs, and book stands
- [ ] Log in to the payment device with your unique code and scan in the boxes
  For POS device instructions, click here
- [ ] Sort boxes by category, place in front of corresponding tables, and unbox
- [ ] Arrange books for maximum viewing — bring tables away from walls

Advertising Schedule

- [ ] **6 weeks before:** Post Save the Date on all social media, parish bulletin, and newsletter
- [ ] **5 weeks before:** Share this video on social media; include sign-up link for parents to create accounts
- [ ] **4 weeks before:** Post another Save the Date reminder with this graphic
- [ ] **3 weeks before:** Highlight select titles your staff and teachers enjoy; explain how sales benefit the school
- [ ] **2 weeks before:** Have principal send an invitation to the community with fair schedule
- [ ] **1 week before:** Set out Sneak Peek flyers in common areas and school newsletter
- [ ] **Evening before:** Post kickoff graphic on social media

During the Fair (Daily Posts)

- [ ] **Day 1:** Kick off with the Reading Challenge
- [ ] **Day 2:** Post this graphic; remind community about in-person times/location + online ordering
- [ ] **Day 3:** Share reading recommendations by age and grade level
- [ ] **Day 4:** Share the top 5 most popular titles so far
- [ ] **Day 5:** Encourage "Stop, Drop and Read" — 20 min daily family reading habit
- [ ] **Day 6:** Thank everyone; ask parents to share their favorite picks
- [ ] **Day 7:** Last day — final reminder that purchases earn 30% back for the school

FINAL

Have a Wonderful Book Fair!

Reach out to your Book Fair Manager if any issues arise — we're here to cheer you on and give you advice and support along the way!